Gemini Notebook (formerly NotebookLM) · about 30 minutes · 12 steps

Turn your paper into a podcast

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Gemini Notebook reads a paper you give it. It can make a short podcast of two voices talking about it, a mind map, and a quiz. It answers only from your paper and shows where it found each answer.

You will need

- A Google account (Gmail) and its password
- Your published paper, or an open course reading, saved as a PDF
- Speakers or headphones to listen
- A pen, to tick each step when you finish it

How to use this guide

- There is one step on each page. Do what the page says, then turn the page.
- A red box shows where to click:

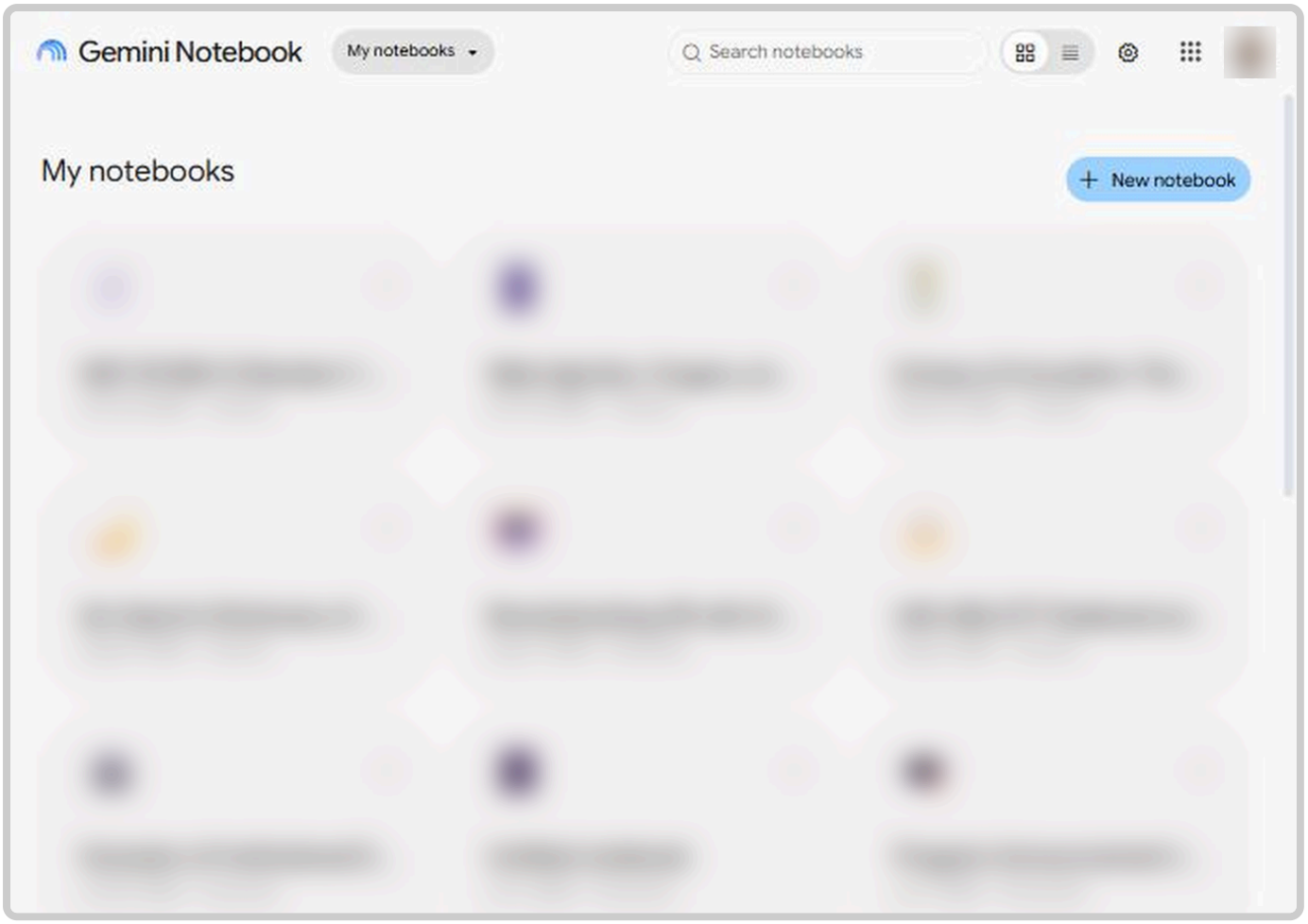
   Click inside the red box. The red arrow points to it.
- Under the big picture there is often a larger picture of the same place.
- Your screen may look a little different. Look for the same words.
- Take your time. Nothing breaks if you click the wrong thing.

1

Step 1 of 12

Open Gemini Notebook

1. Click the long box at the very top of your browser, type **notebooklm.google** and press **Enter**.
2. Sign in with your Google account.



When you are signed in, you see your notebooks. (They are hidden in this picture.)

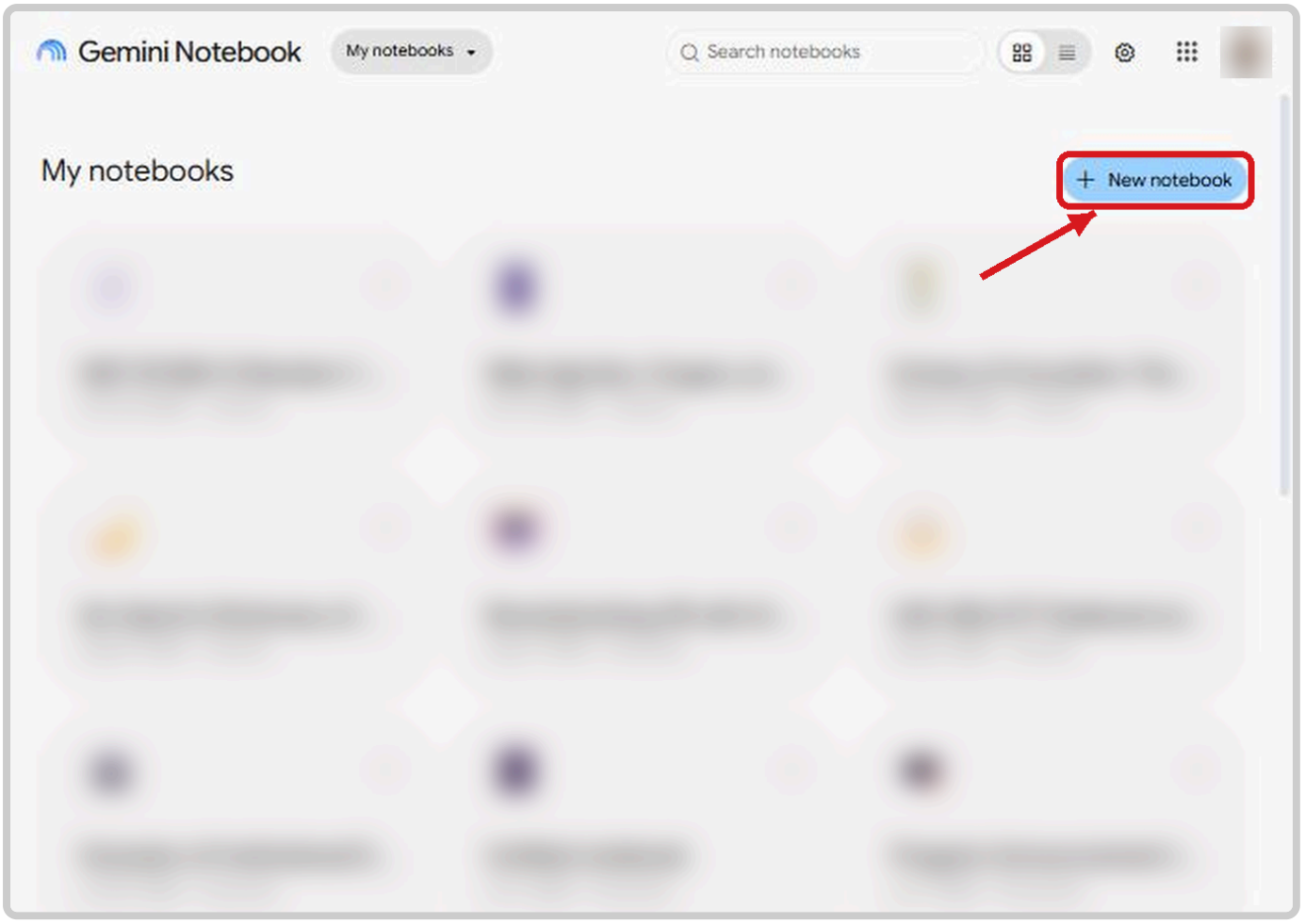
☐ Done? Tick the box and turn the page.

2

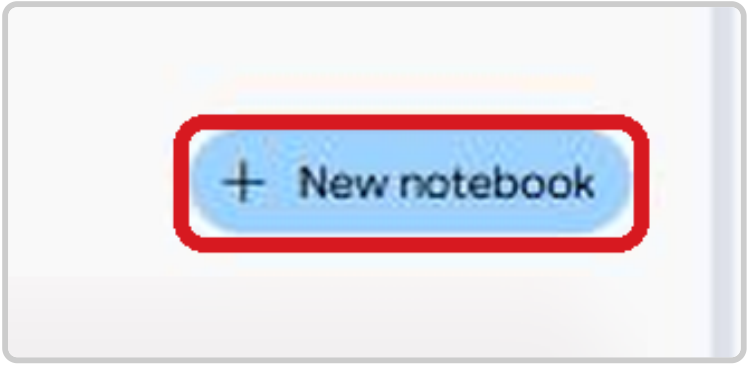
Step 2 of 12

Make a new notebook

1. Click **New notebook**.



Look for this:



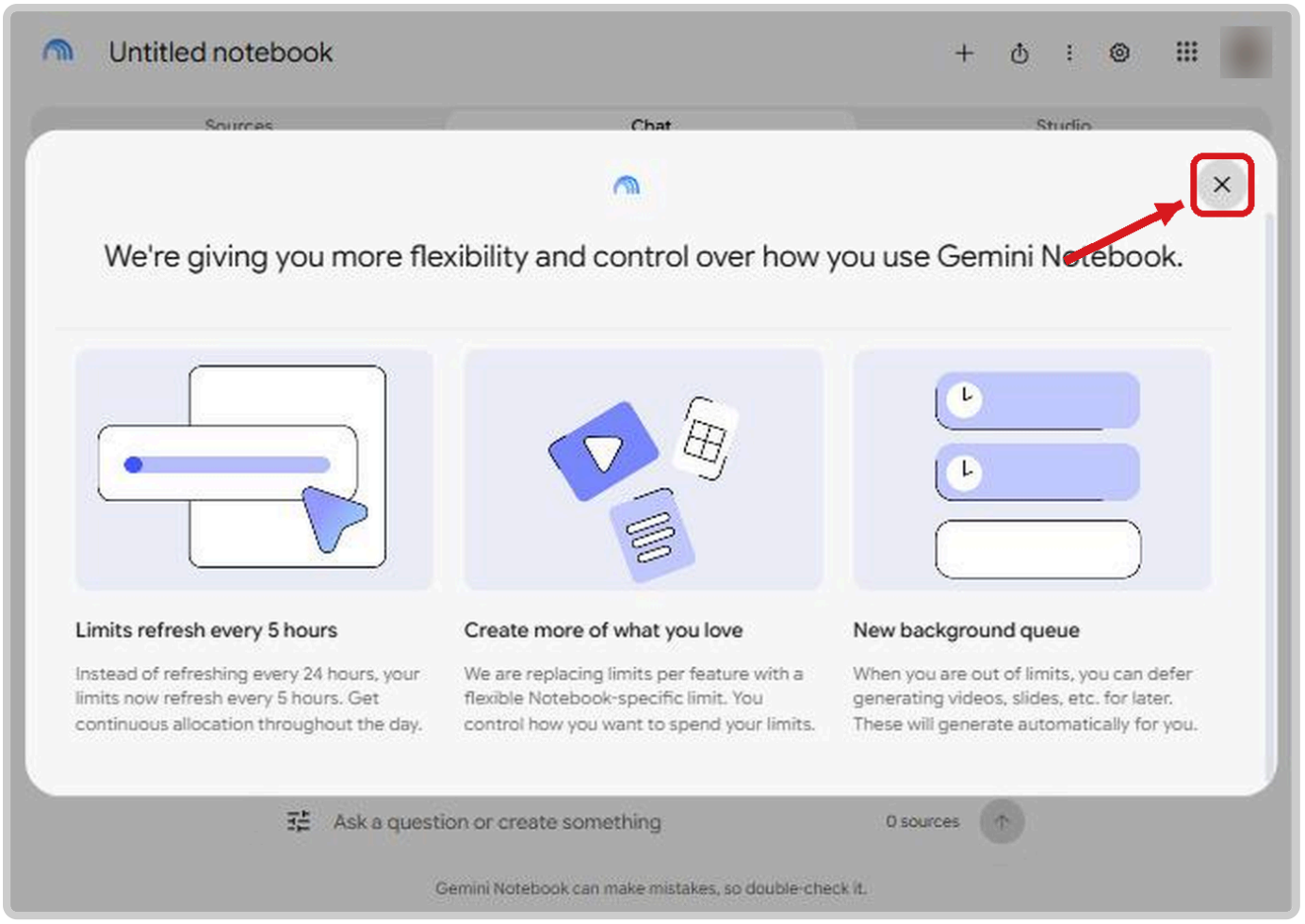
☐ Done? Tick the box and turn the page.

3

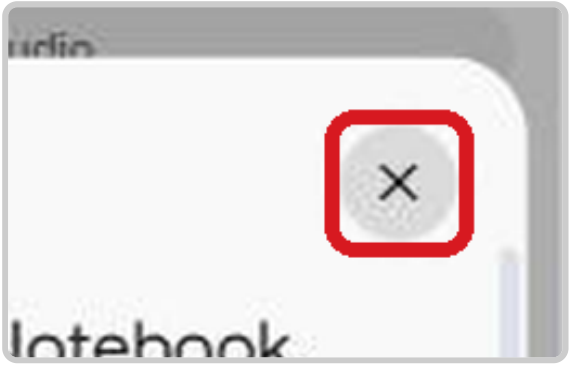
Step 3 of 12

Close any message box

1. If a box like this appears, click the × in its corner.



Look for this:



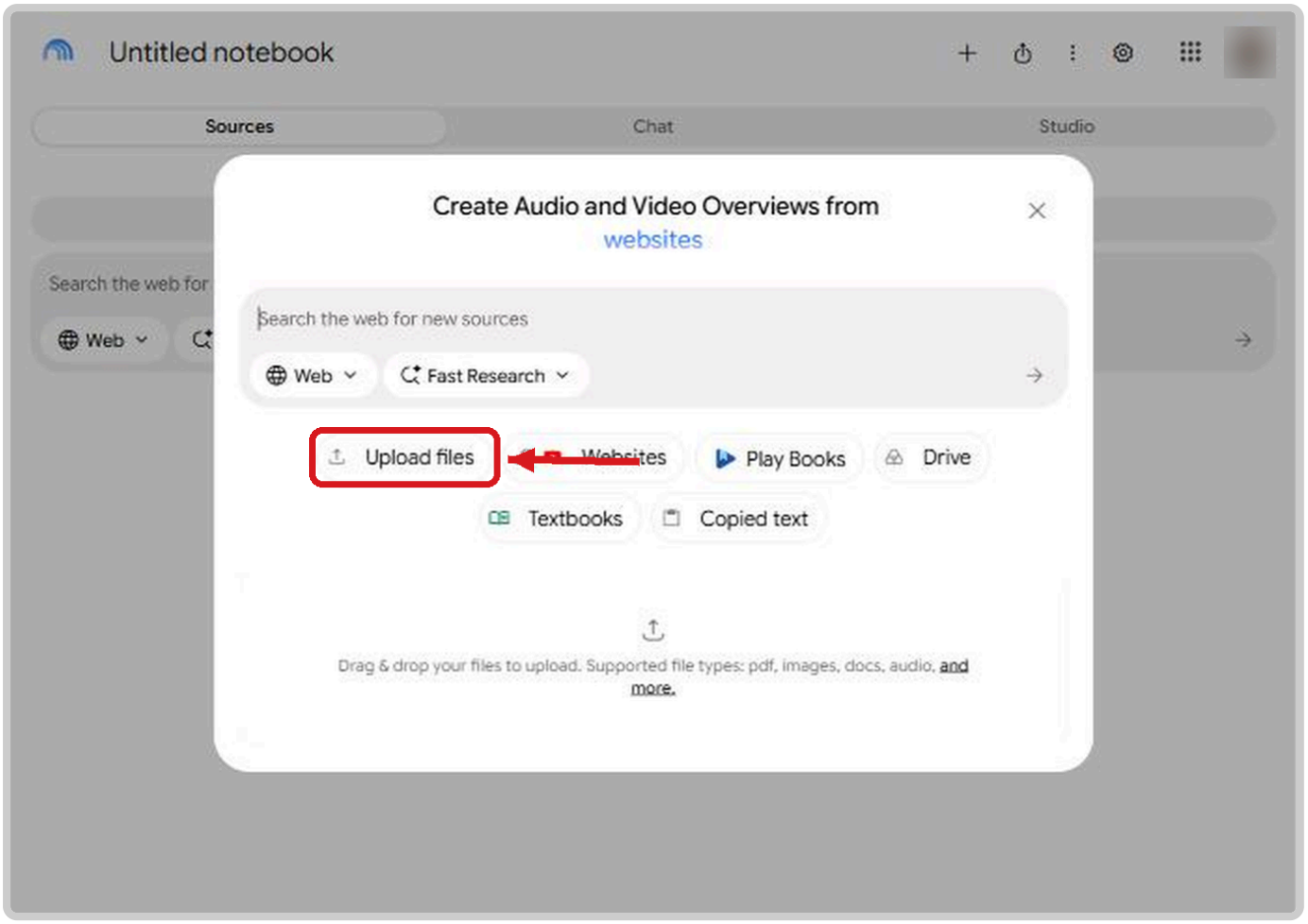
Tip: This works for any message box that gets in your way.

☐ Done? Tick the box and turn the page.

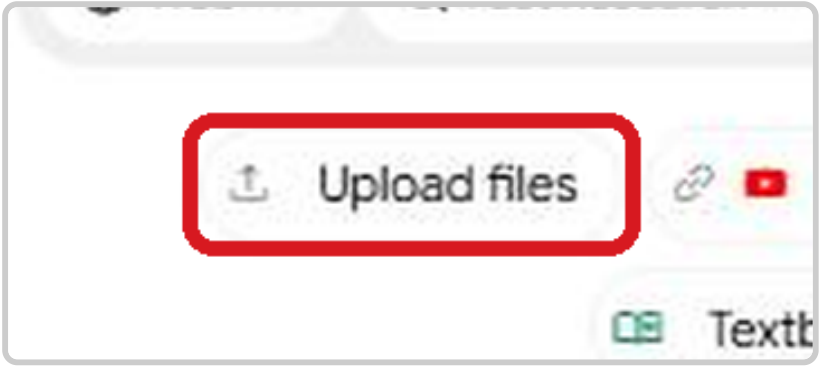
Step 4 of 12

4 Add your paper

1. Click **Upload files**.
2. Click your paper once, then click **Open**. Wait until its name appears.



Look for this:



Tip: No box? Click **Sources**, then **Add sources**.

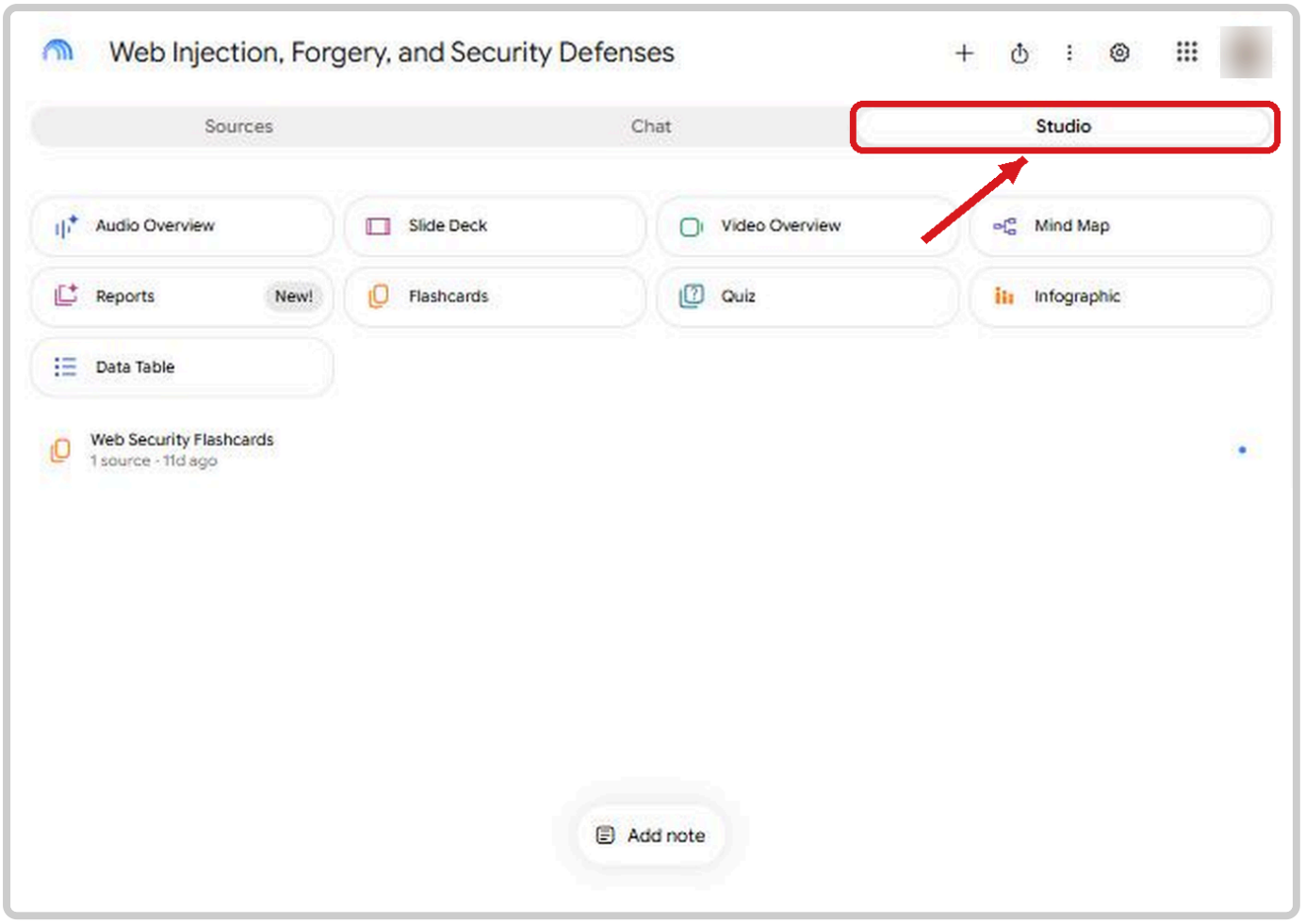
☐ Done? Tick the box and turn the page.

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Step 5 of 12

Open the Studio

1. Click **Studio** at the top.



Look for this:



Tip: On a wide screen you see three columns instead: Sources, Chat and Studio. Studio is the column on the right.

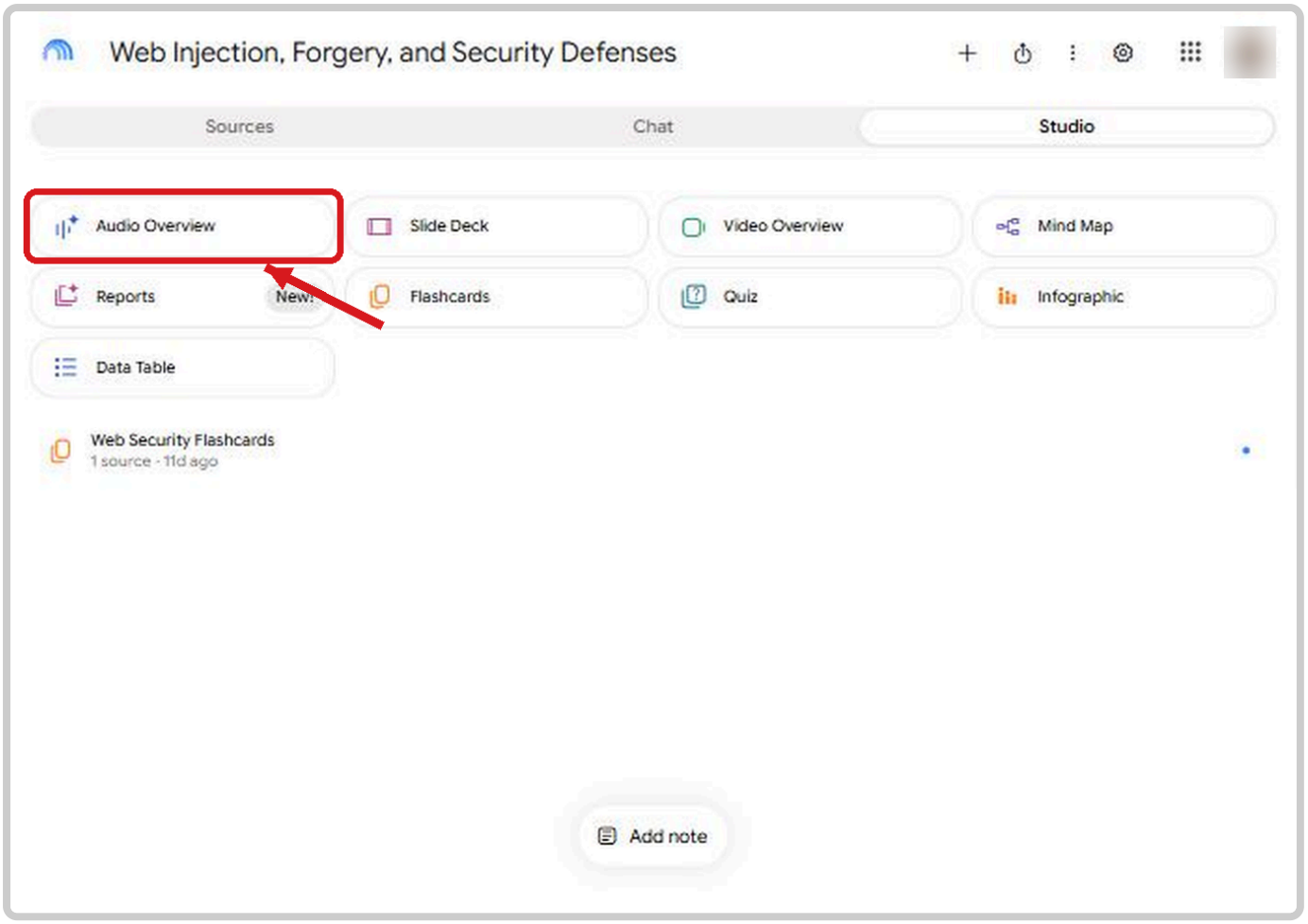
☐ Done? Tick the box and turn the page.

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Step 6 of 12

Start the podcast

1. Move the mouse over **Audio Overview**.
2. Click the small arrow **›** at its right end. A box opens where you can choose how the podcast sounds.



Tip: If you click the middle of the tile instead, the podcast starts with the normal settings. That is fine too.

☐ Done? Tick the box and turn the page.

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Step 7 of 12

Choose how it sounds

1. **Format:** choose **The Critique** for your own paper, or **Deep Dive**.
2. **Language:** choose **English** or **Urdu**.
3. **Prompt box:** type, for example: *Explain this paper for third-year students. Focus on the method and its limits.*
4. Click **Generate**. It takes a few minutes, so you can carry on with the next steps.

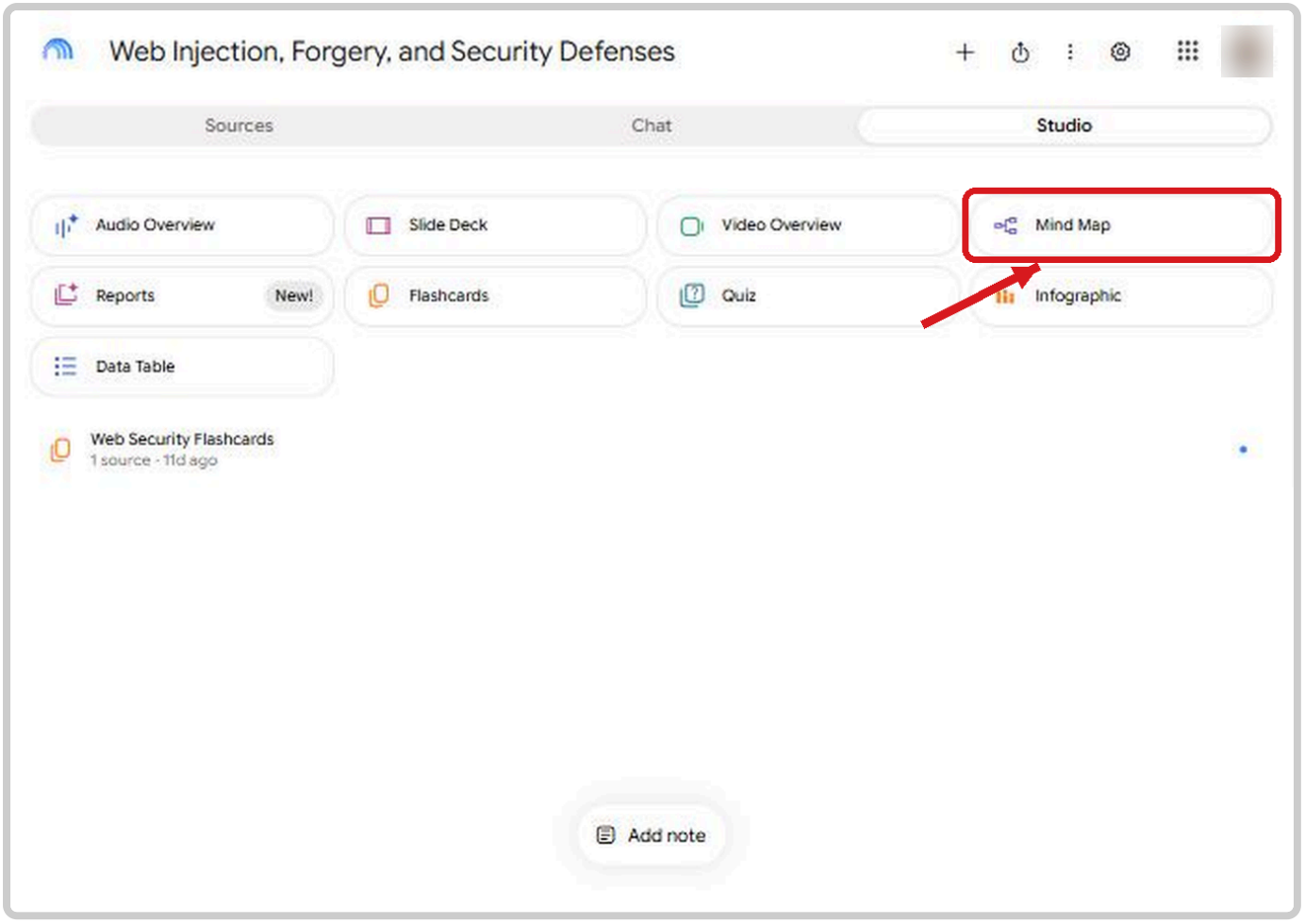
> The free plan allows about 3 podcasts a day, so make one at a time.

☐ Done? Tick the box and turn the page.

Step 8 of 12

8 Look at the mind map

1. While you wait, click **Mind Map**.
2. It shows the main ideas of your paper as a picture.



Look for this:



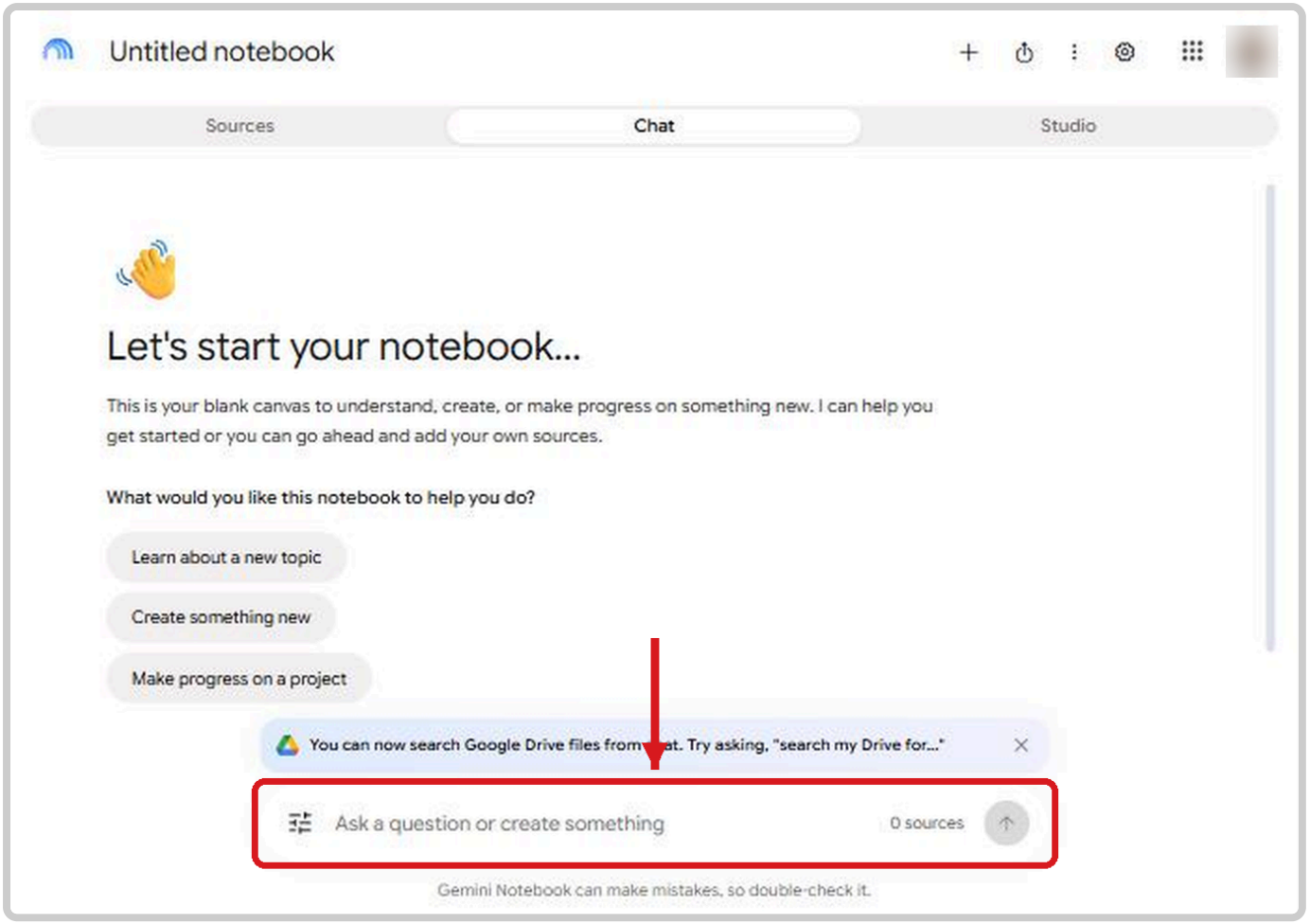
☐ Done? Tick the box and turn the page.

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Step 9 of 12

Ask a question about your paper

1. Click **Chat** at the top.
2. Click the box at the bottom, type a question and press **Enter**.
3. The small numbers in the answer show where it found the information. Click a number to check it.



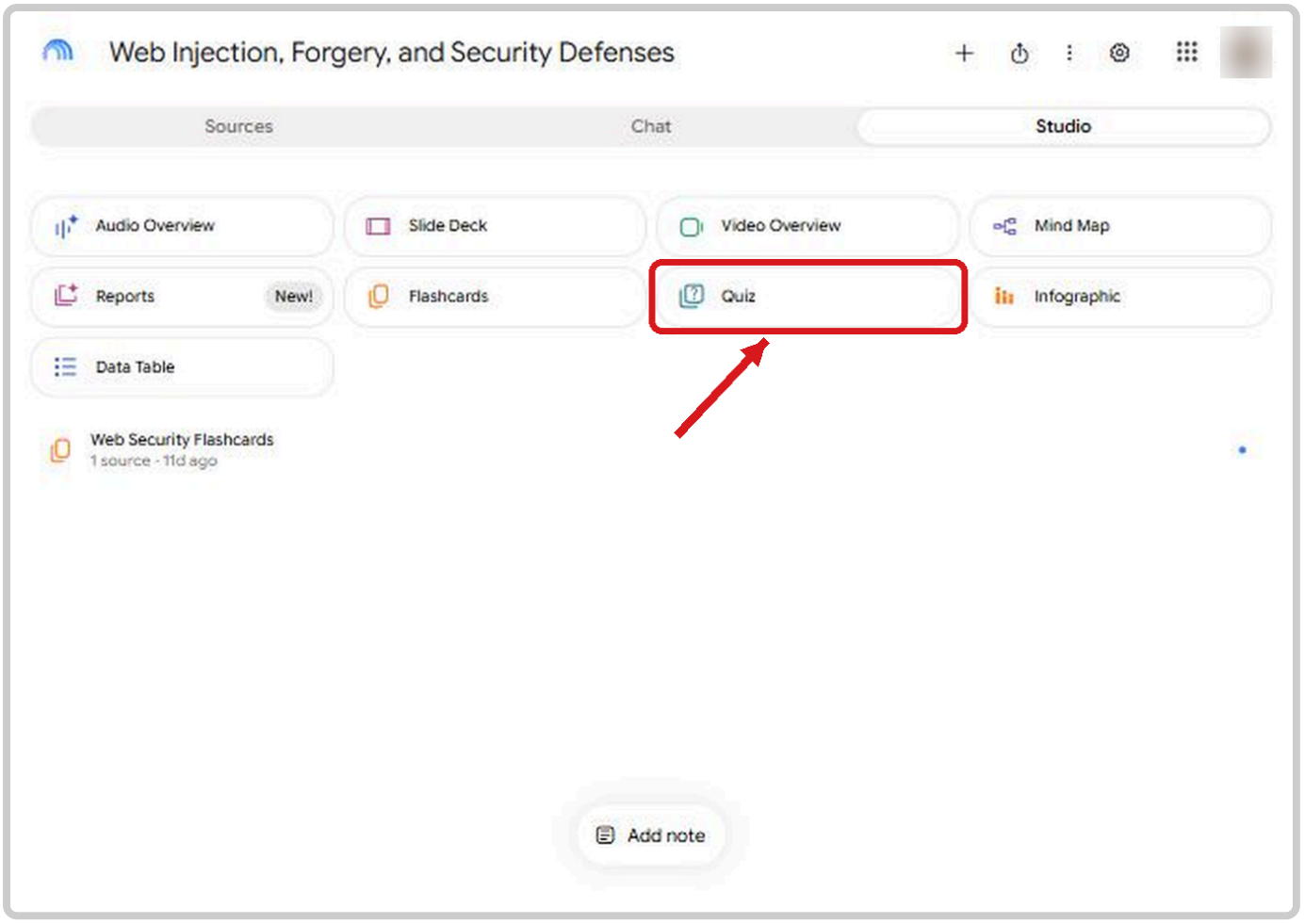
☐ Done? Tick the box and turn the page.

10

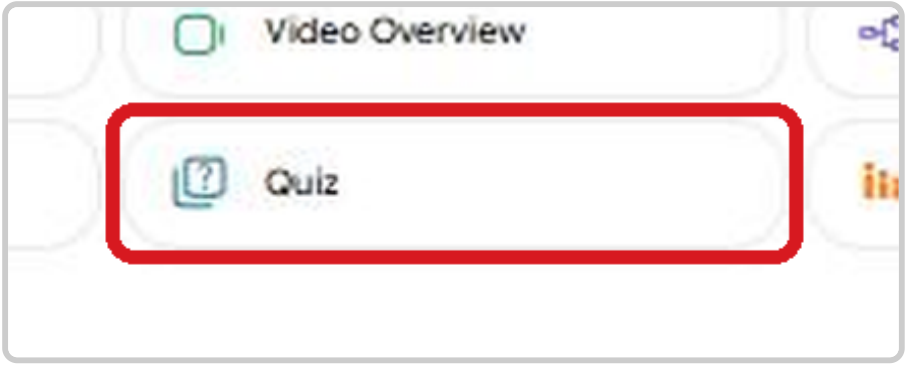
Step 10 of 12

Make a quiz

1. Click **Studio** again, then click **Quiz**.



Look for this:



☐ Done? Tick the box and turn the page.

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Step 11 of 12

Listen and save the podcast

1. When it is ready, the podcast appears in the Studio list under the buttons.
2. Click it to play.
3. To save it, click the three dots ⋮ next to it, then **Download**.

> Listen to the first two minutes. Did it get anything about your paper wrong?

☐ Done? Tick the box and turn the page.

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Step 12 of 12

Put it in Sakai

1. **Podcast:** in Sakai, click **Resources**, then **Add**, then **Upload Files**. Choose the audio file you downloaded.
2. **Quiz:** check the questions, then type the best ones into **Tests & Quizzes**.
3. **Mind map:** download it or take a picture of the screen, and add it to a Lessons page.

> Upload only published papers or open readings. Never upload student work or exams.

☐ Done? Tick the box and turn the page.

If you get stuck

- **A box is in the way:** click the × in its corner, or press the **Esc** key.
- **Nothing happens:** wait 10 seconds. Some steps are slow.
- **The page looks wrong:** press the **F5** key to reload it.
- **You are asked to sign in again:** sign in, then go back to the step you were on.
- **You cannot find a button:** look for the same words somewhere else on the screen. Websites change their layout from time to time.
- **Still stuck:** write down the step number and ask the workshop trainer or a colleague.

Keep safe

- Never upload student names, ID numbers, marks or unreleased exams.
- Upload only material you would be happy for anyone to read.

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